

WILL MCGOWAN

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EDUCATION

University of Strathclyde, Glasgow

Sep 2023 - Jun 2027 (expected)

BA (Hons) Economics

- Average grade to date: 2:1
- **Relevant Modules:** Treasury Management and Derivatives; Industrial Economics; Applied Econometrics

Dissertation | MATLAB

In progress, due 2027

"Does the News Pay? Forecasting European Gas Volatility with MIDAS, Storage and Text Data"

- Testing whether news attention improves forecasts of TTF gas price volatility using mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models, and whether better forecasts add value in a volatility-targeted futures strategy
- Constructing an original gas-market attention index from Google Trends, alongside published geopolitical and policy uncertainty indices

FX Risk Management | group project

Treasury Management and Derivatives

- Assessed how six global companies, including Toyota, Nestlé, NVIDIA and Reliance Industries, are exposed to and manage currency risk on both the revenue and cost side

Empirical CAPM Test

MATLAB

- Tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries (JKP global factor data): zero alpha rejected for 32% at 5% and jointly (GRS) in 48 of 52 countries, with momentum and value the most persistent

Monte Carlo Option Pricing Engine

MATLAB

- Priced European and Asian options by simulation; a geometric-Asian control variate reduced the standard error of arithmetic-Asian estimates by 97.24% vs plain Monte Carlo

Belfast Royal Academy, Belfast

Jun 2023

- A-levels: Mathematics (A), Economics (A), Computer Science (B)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Le Set, Glasgow | Head Mixologist

Sep 2026 - Present

- Created 4 original house cocktails and wrote the specifications for the 7 classics on the menu of a new 200-cover restaurant and cocktail lounge, opened Sep 2026
- Wrote batch specifications for 5 prebatched cocktails and trained around 15 bar staff to prepare and serve them consistently

KONG, Glasgow | Mixologist and Front of House

Oct 2024 - Jun 2026

- Analysed sales patterns to refine upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%
- Reconciled cash and card takings at the end of each shift and trained new staff on drink specifications, POS workflows and licensing compliance

LEADERSHIP AND ACTIVITIES

Strathclyde Agricapital Society | Co-Founder and Treasurer

Sep 2025 - Present

- Co-founded the university's first agri-finance society and grew membership to 126
- Led weekly research sessions on agribusiness transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, breaking down deal rationale, structure and valuation for members
- Manage the society's budget and accounts as Treasurer

Strathclyde Poker Society | Vice-President, then President

Sep 2025 - Apr 2026

- Ran weekly tournaments for around 60 players on a £600-per-semester budget, reconciling every buy-in and prize pool

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Technical: Excel, R, MATLAB, Python, Git

Interests: chess, 14th at the Irish U19 Chess Championships (2023) and won 21 of 22 games in a simultaneous exhibition against players averaging 1860 FIDE; powerlifting, Northern Ireland U19 champion (2023)